

Observation Guide

Algorithms That Choose Us · Feed Archaeology · [Anonymized Institution]

PHASE 3.2 — A PEER'S FEED

Instructions: Open Instagram, TikTok, or YouTube on your phone. Scroll through the feed for 2 to 3 minutes before answering. Do not post, do not like — just observe. For each question, there is a "case mirror": the same question applied to what happened to Mariana. Use this connection to guide your answer.

3.1 — THE MIRROR

Observing my own feed | 20 minutes | Individual, in silence

Platform observed: ☐ Instagram ☐ TikTok ☐ YouTube ☐ Other: _____

A — WHAT DOMINATES MY FEED

- **Case mirror:** What themes dominated Mariana's YouTube feed regarding technology and diversity?
- What themes and topics appear most frequently in your feed? List the top 3 to 5.
- **Case mirror:** What profile of person appeared as a reference for leadership and success in Mariana's feed?
- What types of creators or profiles appear the most? (gender, ethnicity, geographical origin, field of expertise)

B — WHAT IS ABSENT

- **Case mirror:** What voices were absent from Mariana's feed that could have changed her opinion about algorithms and diversity?
 - What voices or perspectives are absent from your feed, but you think should be there?
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C — SYNTHESIS AND CONNECTION TO THE CASE

- **Case mirror:** Is the bias that affected Mariana an isolated case or is it structural? Does the mechanism you found in both feeds help answer this question?
- What type of bias did you identify in your peer's feed — data, design, or feedback bias? Is it the same type you found in your own feed?

F — SYNTHESIS AND CONNECTION TO THE CASE

- **Case mirror:** "When I took my peer's phone, it didn't look like the same YouTube. It looked like another country. That's when I understood what happened to Mariana." —

How would you complete this sentence based on what you have just experienced?

- In one sentence: what discovery about the algorithm did you make by comparing the two feeds that you wouldn't have been able to see just by observing your own?
- *Before returning the phone: share with your peer the most important discovery you made while observing their feed. Listen to what they discovered while observing yours. These discoveries will be the raw material for the Pattern Map (Phase 3.3).*